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Unit – 5 : Session – 3 | Profession and Professional Ethics

■ Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

- Q1. PROFESSION IN THE CONTEXT OF THE COMPREHENSIVE HUMAN GOAL: my profession is not merely a means of earning — it is my channel of PARTICIPATION in the larger order: whatever I engineer, heal, teach or manage either serves or subverts the four-part human goal (right understanding in every self, prosperity in every family, fearlessness in society, co-existence in nature). Seen this way, the question of any profession shifts from 'how much does it pay?' to 'how does it participate?' — the professional becomes a trustee of competence for mutual fulfilment, not a seller of skill to the highest bidder.
- Q2. PROFESSIONAL ETHICS VIA RIGHT UNDERSTANDING: when the professional has right understanding, ethics is not an external code but the natural expression of clarity: (a) clarity of the human goal → the work is directed to mutual fulfilment; (b) clarity of relationship → honesty, fairness and care toward clients, colleagues and society become intrinsic; (c) clarity of co-existence → right utilisation and protection of nature guide every design and process. FEATURES of such ethics: it is UNIVERSAL (same everywhere), RATIONAL (understood, not imposed), SELF-ENFORCED (from natural acceptance, not fear of penalty) and ALL-ENCOMPASSING (covering intention, behaviour and the impact of the product).
- Q3. WHY PREVAILING APPROACHES ARE INADEQUATE: (1) RULES AND CODES of conduct — external, loophole-ridden, obeyed out of fear; they produce compliance, not ethics, and fail the moment supervision lapses (corruption scandals persist despite thick rulebooks). (2) PUNISHMENT AND INCENTIVE — assumes humans are driven only by fear and greed; it reinforces the very assumption ('gain is everything') that causes unethical conduct. (3) VALUE-NEUTRAL TECHNICAL EDUCATION — trains competence without direction, producing professionals who CAN do anything and ask only whether it pays. All three fail because they never touch the Self's understanding; ethics cannot be policed in — it must be educated in.
- Q4. ONE PROFESSION FROM MY BRANCH (COMPUTER SCIENCE) for the universal human order: a SOFTWARE ENGINEER with right understanding participates by designing technology that is people-friendly and eco-friendly — e.g., building platforms for education, health and transparent exchange rather than attention-extraction and addiction-driven products; writing efficient systems that save energy; ensuring data dignity and privacy as an expression of respect for the user. Such an engineer measures success by mutual fulfilment created, not engagement harvested — thereby serving education-sanskar, justice and co-existence through daily work.